

BNHS MASTER CLEAN RAG KNOWLEDGE BASE

25-page project corpus for the BNHS nature-engagement platform

Prepared from the BNHS material supplied in this conversation: collected website/activity content, the 141st Annual Report (Draft, FY 2024–25), and the Memorandum of Association / Rules & Regulations.

01 — Corpus Guide & BNHS Overview

RAG metadata: section=01 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Corpus purpose

This document is a curated BNHS knowledge base for a prototype engagement platform. It combines the useful portions of the supplied BNHS activity material, the 141st Annual Report for 2024–2025, and the Memorandum of Association / Rules & Regulations.

How to use it

Use the corpus for descriptive questions about BNHS, activities, education, conservation, membership, volunteering, research, and historical programme information. Use structured application data for live registrations, availability and user-specific recommendations.

Source scope

The Annual Report supplied is a draft report for 1 April 2024 to 31 March 2025. The Rules & Regulations supplied are effective from 1 April 2022. Activity dates and fees in the collected activity material are snapshots and may change.

Core BNHS engagement journey

The supplied material supports a journey from nature discovery and learning to participation, community engagement, volunteering, membership and conservation contribution.

High-value intents

Activity discovery; nature learning; birdwatching; wildlife; photography; tree walks; marine walks; flamingo walks; education; conservation; volunteering; membership; research; publications.

Corpus design principle

The knowledge base intentionally keeps information that can support realistic participant, member, learner, volunteer and conservation questions. Low-value administrative material has been excluded.

02 — Nature Activities: Bird & Nature Walks

RAG metadata: section=02 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Overview

BNHS programmes include themed Tree Walks, Bird Walks, Marine Walks, Nature Walks and Flamingo Walks. The Annual Report records 25 members' programmes in and around Mumbai during FY 2024–25.

Vetal Tekdi Bird Walk

The supplied activity material describes a BNHS Awareness Bird Walk at Vetal Tekdi focused on natural heritage, urban forests, climate-stressed futures and conservation of city hills. The walk is approximately 2.5 km and 1.5–2 hours, with binoculars/camera suggested when available.

SGNP Bird Monitoring

The SGNP Bird Monitoring Programme involves bird monitoring and citizen participation in a bird count. Volunteers may be selected and assigned transects; teams include Forest Department staff, a bird expert/team leader and volunteers.

Flamingo and wetland walks

The collected activities include Flamingo Watch at TS Chanakya and a Flamingo & Bird Walk at NRI Pond. These focus on flamingos, wetland habitats and resident wetland birds.

Best RAG questions

Which BNHS activities involve birdwatching? What bird-related activities are available? What is the SGNP Bird Monitoring Programme? What can I expect on a flamingo walk?

03 — Tree, Marine & Urban Biodiversity Walks

RAG metadata: section=03 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Heritage Tree Walk

The Heritage Tree Walk near Kala Ghoda focuses on historic trees of Mumbai, their origins, ecological significance and connection with city history. The supplied material describes it as an easy 1–2 km walk.

Marine Walk at Juhu Beach

The Juhu Marine Walk focuses on intertidal marine life visible during low tide. Examples in the collected material include snails, hermit crabs, burrowing crabs, small bivalves and sea anemones. It is described as an easy 1–2 km walk.

Marine Drive Tree Walk

The Marine Drive Tree Walk focuses on trees and their ecological and cultural significance. The supplied activity description mentions Samudra-phal, Tamanu (Undi) and Breadfruit Tree.

Malabar Hill Tree Walk

This walk focuses on biodiversity, ancient trees, flowering plants, native vegetation and the natural history of Malabar Hill. It is described as an easy 2–3 km walk.

Recommendation tags

Useful tags include trees, urban biodiversity, marine life, coastal ecology, natural history, easy walks, Mumbai, photography and nature observation.

04 — BNHS Nature Reserve & Monsoon Activities

RAG metadata: section=04 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

BNHS Reserve

The supplied material describes the BNHS CEC Mumbai/Nature Reserve as a 33-acre forest reserve supporting diverse biodiversity and habitat for Mumbai leopards. It is positioned between Sanjay Gandhi National Park and the urban forest of Film City.

Monsoon Walk

The Monsoon Walk at BNHS Reserve focuses on monsoon forest biodiversity and wildlife observation. Species mentioned in the collected material include Rufous Woodpecker, Vigors's Sunbird, Tickell's Blue Flycatcher, Common Leopard Butterfly, stick insects, praying mantis, lynx spiders, nursery web spiders and harvestman.

Temple Trail

The Temple Trail at BNHS Reserve focuses on seasonal wildflowers, fungi, insects, spiders, butterflies and birds, and explores ecological relationships in the monsoon forest.

Macrofauna Trail

The Macrofauna Trail emphasizes forest biodiversity, including seasonal wildflowers, fungi, insects, spiders, butterflies and birds.

Recommendation value

These activities are strong candidates for users interested in biodiversity, insects, butterflies, birds, forest ecology, monsoon nature and beginner-friendly nature observation.

05 — Matheran Herpetofauna Camp

RAG metadata: section=05 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Activity profile

The Matheran Herpetofauna Camp is focused on reptiles and amphibians, including their ecology, behaviour, conservation and observation in natural habitats.

Audience

The collected description identifies nature enthusiasts, students, photographers and wildlife lovers as target participants.

Learning format

Highlights include a guided night herpetofauna trail and a guided morning nature trail, with expert guidance from BNHS naturalists.

Species examples

The supplied material mentions Bamboo Pit Viper, Green Vine Snake, Common Wolf Snake, Deccan Banded Gecko, bush frogs, shieldtails and skinks.

Operational details

The supplied snapshot gives 21–22 August 2026, Matheran in the Western Ghats, and fees of Rs 2,450 for members and Rs 2,950 for non-members. Accommodation and meals are not included. Outdoor activities may be modified according to weather and safety conditions.

RAG questions

Who is the Matheran Herpetofauna Camp for? What species may be observed? What are the camp activities? Where is the camp held?

06 — Education: CEC Mumbai

RAG metadata: section=06 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Mission

CEC Mumbai at Goregaon works to create awareness and concern about nature among students, educators, government employees, corporate bodies and the general public.

Activities

The supplied material lists nature walks, workshops, certificate courses, public outreach, corporate CSR programmes, online-hybrid biodiversity courses and visits to the BNHS Nature Reserve.

Certificate-course subjects

Subjects mentioned include ornithology, herpetology, biodiversity conservation, butterfly studies, botany and marine conservation. The collected material states that Class X is sufficient as a basic qualification for applying to these courses.

Annual Report engagement

During April 2024–March 2025, CEC Mumbai recorded 5,902 visitors: 4,566 non-members and 1,336 members. It organized more than 120 programmes including nature trails, workshops, online courses, CSR activities, school/college visits and announced events.

Best intents

What courses does CEC Mumbai offer? What activities happen at CEC Mumbai? Who can participate in CEC programmes? How does CEC support nature education?

07 — Education: CEC Delhi, Nagpur & e-Mammal India

RAG metadata: section=07 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

CEC Delhi

The Conservation Education Centre in Asola Bhatti Wildlife Sanctuary, New Delhi, began operations in 2005. The supplied material describes field-based educational programmes for students and professionals, including school programmes, bird and butterfly surveys, citizen science, a Butterfly Park, Jungle Walk, Delhi Seed Bank and city-forest activities.

Nagpur CEC

The Nagpur CEC conducts walks and competitions to motivate students to observe and appreciate nature. The Mobile Environment Education Unit reaches students living near protected areas through awareness programmes.

e-Mammal India

e-Mammal India engages students and teachers in generating wildlife data for scientists using camera traps. The supplied material identifies children aged 11–14 as the focus and describes camera-trapping, scientific research methods, competitions, film screenings and lectures.

Recommendation tags

Education, students, teachers, citizen science, birds, butterflies, camera traps, wildlife data, field learning, biodiversity.

RAG questions

What is e-Mammal India? What does CEC Delhi offer? What does the Nagpur CEC do? Which BNHS education initiative involves camera traps?

08 — Courses, Field Camps & Experiential Learning

RAG metadata: section=08 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Hybrid courses

The Annual Report describes hybrid certificate courses combining live expert webinars, on-ground field visits and camps, practical identification and research skills, peer presentations and wrap-up sessions. 115 participants from across India enrolled in the described course activity.

Amboli

The August 2024 Amboli field camp focused on herpetology. Species/examples included Malabar Gliding Frog, Amboli Toad, Banded Gecko, Pit Vipers and Vine Snakes.

Goa

September 2024 and January 2025 field camps in Goa focused on ornithology and herpetology. Sites included Bhagwan Mahavir Wildlife Sanctuary, Bondla Sanctuary and Tambdi Surla. The report notes 95+ bird species, including Malabar Hornbill and Hill Myna, as well as Luna Moth, Skittering Frogs and five Pit Vipers.

Bharatpur–Chambal

The February–March 2025 field camp focused on avifauna and wetland ecology. Sites included Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary and the Chambal River. Highlights included Indian Skimmers, Painted Storks and Gharials, along with interaction with BNHS conservation scientists.

Recommendation value

These records provide strong content for matching users by interests such as ornithology, herpetology, wetland ecology, field research, bird identification and wildlife observation.

09 — Signature Events & Virtual Engagement

RAG metadata: section=09 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

World Environment Day

The Annual Report describes the 5 June 2024 World Environment Day theme as 'Know Your Trees'. Trails were conducted at BNHS CEC Mumbai and Nehru Science Centre, focusing on tree identification and ecology.

Wildlife Week

During 4–6 October 2024, the programme included a Karvi Trail with flowering observations, screening of BNHS conservation work on the MTHL project, and interactive sessions on butterflies, birding and flora.

Butterfly Festival

The 19–20 October 2024 Butterfly Festival included an egg-to-butterfly life-cycle walk, forest trails, butterfly spotting and children's drawing sessions.

Walk in the Woods

Monthly forest walks were led by naturalists for BNHS members, with seasonal biodiversity interpretation and birding.

Webinars

The Annual Report notes expert webinars with more than 100 participants. Topics included conservation breeding, avian crisis and rescue, and grassland bird conservation covering the Great Indian Bustard and Lesser Florican.

RAG questions

What happens during Wildlife Week? What is Walk in the Woods? What was the Know Your Trees event? What webinar topics were offered?

10 — School, College & Youth Engagement

RAG metadata: section=10 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

CEC academic engagement

CEC Mumbai welcomed more than 40 academic institutions during the reporting period.

Children's Day Week

In November 2024, 601 students from three schools explored CEC trails, biodiversity videos and interactive sessions.

College engagement

Ramnarain Ruia College's Life Sciences Department explored butterfly and plant interactions. S. P. Jain College participated in a sustainable CSR-focused nature trail and biodiversity session.

Children's Academy

More than 500 students in multiple batches explored the BNHS Nature Reserve. Visits included biodiversity presentations and conservation discussions.

Forest Owlet Conservation Day

On 24 October 2024, BNHS-EIACP engaged 130 students at Z.P. School, Mahuli village near Tansa Wildlife Sanctuary. The programme included a documentary, bird ecology and identification, and information material about Maharashtra's birds.

Recommendation value

This content supports student-focused recommendations and questions about school visits, educational trails, biodiversity learning and youth conservation engagement.

11 — Membership: Categories & Engagement

RAG metadata: section=11 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Membership role

The Membership Department is described as a community-engagement channel that builds a sense of belonging and supports programmes and city/state chapters.

Categories recorded in the Annual Report

The FY 2024–25 membership table includes Life, Annual, Annual 3 years, Annual 5 years, Student, Institutional, Armed Forces, Family of Four, Family (Life) Couple, Complimentary List, Family Couple, Friends of BNHS Gold, Life Foreign, Ordinary Foreign, Friends of BNHS Platinum and Life SAARC.

Membership totals

The report records a total of 3,940 at opening and 3,900 at 31 March 2025 in the presented membership table.

Engagement trend

Life Membership increased from 2,372 to 2,483. New members were 454 and renewals were 205 in 2024–25, for 659 total members gained.

City/state chapters

The report describes outreach in Bengaluru, Jodhpur and Ajmer through nature trails and bird walks, linking membership with local biodiversity engagement.

RAG questions

What membership categories are recorded? How many members were gained? What are BNHS city/state chapters?

12 — Membership Rules & Member Privileges

RAG metadata: section=12 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Membership admission

The Rules & Regulations state that membership election is vested in the Governing Council. Candidates other than Honorary Members are proposed and recommended in writing by one or more members and accepted by the Council.

Student membership

A student of a recognised educational institution may be eligible for student membership on producing proof from the institution. The supplied rules state that student membership cannot be availed of by persons over 25 years of age.

Member privileges

Members have rights to attend and vote at general meetings, attend Society meetings and functions, propose candidates for the Governing Council, and access Society collections with prior permission.

Library

Members may access the Society Library and borrow books for a stated period, except rare books and books required for constant reference. The rules provide for fines for late returns and replacement/payment for lost or damaged books.

Publications

The rules state that members can receive the Society's Journal in soft copy on written request and receive a hard copy of Hornbill. Members may also purchase Society publications at prices below the published price as fixed by the Council.

Important caveat

These are membership rules from the supplied document, effective from 1 April 2022; do not treat them as current commercial pricing or live membership availability.

13 — BNHS-SEVA & Volunteering

RAG metadata: section=13 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

BNHS-SEVA

The Annual Report describes BNHS-SEVA as a structured volunteer programme intended to increase member involvement in conservation and research.

Volunteer matching

More than 90 members volunteered. Volunteers were matched with BNHS staff and scientists to align their skills and interests with meaningful work.

Departments supported

The report specifically mentions support for the Central Marketing Department, Publications and Library.

Why this matters for the platform

This is a strong basis for a skill-and-interest matching feature. A participant profile can contain interests and skills; volunteer opportunities can contain required skills and conservation themes; the system can recommend relevant opportunities.

Corporate participation

Corporate membership also included employee engagement opportunities such as volunteering at BNHS centres, EcoDay events and expert-led sessions.

RAG questions

What is BNHS-SEVA? How were volunteers matched? Which departments received volunteer support?

14 — Corporate Membership & CSR Engagement

RAG metadata: section=14 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Corporate membership

The Annual Report describes a revitalised Corporate Membership Programme intended to align organizational CSR goals with conservation efforts.

Benefits listed

The report lists sustainable gifting options, priority access to the resource-rich library, discounts on exclusive merchandise, employee engagement opportunities, and visibility in Hornbill.

Employee engagement

Examples include volunteering at BNHS centres, EcoDay events and expert-led sessions.

CSR field activities

The Annual Report describes tree plantation drives and engagement activities. Performance Cars planted 500 native saplings in Navi Mumbai, while Infinity Cars planted 2,000 saplings across Maharashtra.

Species planted

Examples include Jamun (*Syzygium cumini*), Jackfruit, Amla, Arjun, Karanj and Jarul.

Other activities

Corporate teams participated in bund-building, fireline maintenance and kitchen-garden creation.

RAG value

Useful for questions about BNHS CSR, corporate participation, employee volunteering and conservation-oriented engagement.

15 — Vulture Conservation

RAG metadata: section=15 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Vulture Conservation Breeding Centre, Assam

The Annual Report describes a long-term goal of conservation breeding of White-rumped Vulture and Slender-billed Vulture, with a stated objective of reintroduction into the wild.

Objectives

Objectives include maintaining vulture stock, conservation breeding, and re-introduction of White-rumped and Slender-billed Vultures.

Vulture Safe Zone, Assam

The project covers multiple districts and includes pharmacy surveys for NSAIDs, monitoring wild and breeding vulture populations, recording causes of death and contamination, monitoring ungulate carcasses, awareness and advocacy, preparation for trial releases and response to poison-bait incidents.

Public learning

The Annual Report also describes a webinar on the threats faced by vultures and ongoing conservation efforts.

RAG questions

What is the Vulture Conservation Breeding Centre? Which vulture species are involved? What is the Vulture Safe Zone? What threats are being addressed?

16 — Indian Skimmer & Black-bellied Tern Conservation

RAG metadata: section=16 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Chambal project

The Annual Report describes research and conservation of sandbar-nesting birds with focus on Indian Skimmer and Black-bellied Tern in the National Chambal Sanctuary.

Nest monitoring and protection

Nest monitoring was conducted between April and June 2024. Nest protection significantly improved nest survival, and approximately 500 chicks were reported saved from predation and trampling during the 2024 nesting season.

Community participation

Capacity-building programmes were held for Madhya Pradesh Forest Department staff and nest guardians. Awareness programmes were conducted in villages near nesting sites.

Mahanadi project

A project on the River Mahanadi focused on expanding protection and establishing community-based monitoring and conservation models for Indian Skimmer and Black-bellied Tern.

Citizen science

The report states that BNHS carried out the Indian Skimmer Count, described as a citizen-science initiative launched in 2020.

RAG questions

What conservation work does BNHS do for Indian Skimmers? What is the Indian Skimmer Count? How are communities involved?

17 — Great Indian Bustard & Lesser Florican

RAG metadata: section=17 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Great Indian Bustard programme

The Annual Report describes collaboration with the Indian Army to implement a conservation programme for the critically endangered Great Indian Bustard across multiple range states, with focus on the Pokhran Field Firing Range in Jaisalmer.

Conservation methods

Activities included habitat restoration, creation of safe spaces for birds and sensitisation initiatives.

Community involvement

BNHS coordinated with 12 Gram Panchayats in Pokhran Tehsil, engaging local communities in habitat restoration and wildlife conservation.

Reported outcome

The report describes four Great Indian Bustard chicks successfully recruited into the wild population during 2024–25: two near the BNHS base camp at Khetolai and two reared in a Forest Department enclosure at Ramdevra.

Lesser Florican

Grassland bird conservation webinars and Wildlife Week activities also addressed Lesser Florican protection. The report describes a habitat restoration site visit at Sisri-Aurad associated with the Lesser Florican team.

RAG questions

What is BNHS doing for the Great Indian Bustard? How are local communities involved? What is the connection to grassland bird conservation?

18 — Forest Owlet, Wetlands & Avian Awareness

RAG metadata: section=18 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Forest Owlet

The Annual Report describes Forest Owlet Conservation Day on 24 October 2024. The species is identified in the report as *Athene blewitti* and listed there as Endangered on the IUCN Red List.

Education event

BNHS-EIACP engaged 130 students at Mahuli village near Tansa Wildlife Sanctuary. Activities included a documentary, interactive bird ecology and identification, and distribution of Maharashtra bird information.

World Wetlands Day

On 2 February 2025, BNHS-EIACP hosted an interactive exhibition at Parvati Arga Wildlife Sanctuary in Gonda district, Uttar Pradesh, showcasing wetland ecosystems and bird diversity.

Navi Mumbai wetlands

A World Wetlands Day event at Karmaveer Bhaurao Patil College included a session on wetland ecosystems and competitions for students from eight colleges in Navi Mumbai.

Awareness products

The report mentions knowledge products on Storks of India and Sparrows of India, aimed at awareness and conservation.

RAG questions

What is Forest Owlet Conservation Day? What does BNHS do for wetland awareness? What awareness products are mentioned?

19 — Long-term Bird Monitoring & Urban Biodiversity

RAG metadata: section=19 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

NMIA monitoring

The Annual Report describes long-term monitoring of bird diversity around Navi Mumbai International Airport and surrounding areas during construction and operational phases.

Study scope

Monitoring covered seasonal and habitat-wise bird species richness and abundance within a 10 km radius of the airport area. Adjacent mangrove and creek habitats were included.

Wetland surveys

Monthly bird counts were conducted at wetlands including sites in Ulwe, Kharghar, Nerul, Panvel and Raigad, along with vantage points in the Belapur-Panvel Creek area.

Habitat finding

After four consecutive years of intensive sampling, the report states that mangrove habitats had the highest bird species richness while urban habitats had the lowest across all seasons.

Urban academic biodiversity

The report also records biodiversity monitoring at IIT Mumbai, including trees, birds, herpetofauna, insects and mammals, emphasizing the ecological value of varied habitats in urban academic institutions.

RAG questions

How does BNHS monitor birds around NMIA? Which habitats show high bird diversity? What wetland sites are surveyed?

20 — Digitisation, AI & Citizen Participation

RAG metadata: section=20 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Bird-ringing digitisation

The Annual Report describes a digitisation initiative in which 17,402 research notes were scanned and bird-ringing data were extracted from approximately half of them.

AI pipeline

BNHS developed an AI pipeline to transcribe physical research notes into digital data. A user interface allowed volunteers and students to perform quality checks before data were committed to the central database.

Key statistics

The report gives 10,942 sheets processed through the AI pipeline, 8,182 quality checks completed, and 98,859 bird-ringing records added to the database.

Student contribution

About 150 students from St. Joseph's University, Zoology Department, contributed significantly to quality checking.

Virtual Museum

A proof of concept using Omeka was implemented as a repository for digitised specimen collections, publication archives and other research materials. The report states that BNHS is developing a Virtual Museum to improve accessibility.

Project relevance

This is useful for demonstrating that BNHS already combines scientific knowledge, digitisation, AI-assisted processing and volunteer participation.

21 — Research, Library & Publications

RAG metadata: section=21 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

BNHS Library

The collected BNHS material describes the Library as specializing in wildlife, ecology, zoology, botany and environmental conservation.

Resource types

The library material mentions books, journals, scientific reports, theses and natural-history archival material such as photographs, lithographs and transparencies.

Collection figures

The collected material states 24,000+ books, 5,000 bound journal volumes, 1,700 scientific reports, 160 theses and 2,000 rare books.

JBNHS

The Annual Report describes the Journal of the Bombay Natural History Society as published since 1886 and as a long-standing repository of knowledge in natural history, biodiversity and conservation science.

Hornbill

The report describes Hornbill as a key communication tool for BNHS members, presenting conservation and natural-history stories in accessible, non-technical language and providing a platform for member observations and insights.

RAG questions

What subjects does the BNHS Library cover? What is JBNHS? What is Hornbill? What kinds of resources are in the library?

22 — Rules: Subscriptions, Withdrawal & Conduct

RAG metadata: section=22 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Rules version

The supplied Rules & Regulations state that they are effective from 1 April 2022.

Subscriptions

The rules state that annual subscription is due twelve months after the first subscription expires. Members whose subscriptions are in arrears may not exercise membership privileges until restored according to the rules.

Arrears

If an annual subscription remains unpaid for two years, the member is advised that the name may be removed from the membership list after the specified notice period. The Council may restore membership on terms it considers appropriate.

Withdrawal

A member who has paid all fees due may resign by written notice to the Honorary Secretary. The rules state that a resigning member is not entitled to a refund of subscription already paid.

Suspension or expulsion

The Council may suspend or expel a member for willful disobedience of the rules or conduct considered unfit for membership. The rules specify notice, an opportunity to provide an explanation, and a two-thirds voting requirement among Council members present and voting.

RAG questions

What happens when membership fees are overdue? Can a member resign? What does the rule say about suspension or expulsion?

23 — Governance & Organizational Context

RAG metadata: section=23 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Society governance

The Rules & Regulations describe membership as consisting of an unlimited number of members whose election is vested in a Governing Council.

Council and management

The supplied material describes the Society's management and the role of the Governing Council in oversight and organizational matters.

Annual General Meeting

The rules state that an Annual General Meeting is held annually and can receive and adopt the Annual Report and audited statement of accounts, as well as transact other business.

Collaborative work

The Memorandum of Association includes the ability to enter agreements and collaborations with societies or persons having similar or allied objects where such arrangements further the Society's objects.

How to use this section

Governance content is useful for organizational questions, but it should not dominate the retrieval corpus for a participant-facing activity assistant.

Filtering rule

Prefer governance facts that explain membership, organizational roles, collaboration or participation. Avoid injecting detailed financial or internal procedural material into ordinary activity queries.

24 — RAG FAQ & Query Examples

RAG metadata: section=24 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Activity discovery

Which BNHS activities are suitable for birdwatchers? Which activities focus on trees? Which activities involve wetlands? Which activities are suitable for photographers?

Education

What courses are offered by CEC Mumbai? What is e-Mammal India? Which BNHS programmes involve students? What are BNHS hybrid courses?

Conservation

What does BNHS do for vultures? What is the Indian Skimmer conservation programme? What is the Great Indian Bustard programme? What does BNHS do for wetlands?

Membership

What membership categories are described? What are student membership rules? What privileges do members have? What is BNHS-SEVA?

Research

What is JBNHS? What is Hornbill? What does the BNHS Library contain? What is the bird-ringing digitisation project?

Safety and freshness

For current activity dates, fees, availability and registration, the application should consult current structured activity data rather than relying only on historical RAG text.

25 — Implementation Metadata & Data Separation

RAG metadata: section=25 | domain=BNHS | use=knowledge retrieval | freshness=historical/source snapshot

Recommended vector corpus

Use the content in this document for descriptive knowledge: BNHS background, activity descriptions, education, conservation, membership, volunteering, research and historical engagement.

Recommended MongoDB collections

users; activities; registrations; interests; participation_history; volunteer_opportunities; achievements; notifications.

Activity schema fields

activity_name; category; location; date; duration; distance; difficulty; audience; interests; species; fee; member_fee; description; source_date; status.

Recommendation inputs

User interests + previous participation + preferred location + activity category + skill/experience level + current activity metadata.

RAG metadata

source_document; source_type; topic; subtopic; activity_name; location; date; audience; interests; year; document_version.

Architecture

React frontend → Node/Express backend → MongoDB application data. Node/Express can call a Python FastAPI service for recommendations and RAG. Python can use embeddings/vector search and an LLM for knowledge answers.

Final rule

RAG explains and retrieves knowledge. MongoDB provides current application state. The recommendation service ranks activities. This separation reduces retrieval noise and makes the BNHS prototype easier to maintain.